4.4.6 File Management

File management is an important function of OS which handles the data storage techniques. The operating System manages the files, folders and directory systems on a computer.The FAT(File Allocation Table) stores general information about files like filename, type (text or binary), size, starting address and access mode.The file manager of the operating system helps to create, edit, copy, allocate memory to the files and also updates the FAT. There are few other file management techniques available like Next Generation File System (NTFS) and ext2(Linux).

4.4.7 Multi-Processing

This is a one of the features of Operating System. It has two or more processors for a single running process (job). Processing takes place in parallel is known as parallel processing.Since the execution takes place in parallel, this feature is used for high speed execution which increases the power of computing.

4.4.8 Time-sharing

This is a one of the features of Operating Systems. It allows execution of multiple tasks or processes concurrently. For each task a fixed time is allocated. This division of time is called Time- sharing. The processor switches rapidly between various processes after a time is elapsed or the process is completed.

For example assume that there are three processes called P1, P2, P3 and time allocated for each process 30, 40, 50 minutes respectively. If the process P1 completes within 20 minutes then processor takes the next process P2 for the execution. If the process P2 could not complete within 40 minutes, then the current process P2 will be paused and switch over to the next process P3.

4.4.9 Distributed Operating Systems

The Distributed Operating System is used to access shared data and files that reside in any machine around the world using internet/intranet.The users can access as if it is available on their own computer.

The advantages of distributed Operating System are as follows:

- A user at one location can make use of all the resources available at another location over the network.
- Many computer resources can be added easily in the network
- Improves the interaction with the customers and clients.
- Reduces the load on the host computer.

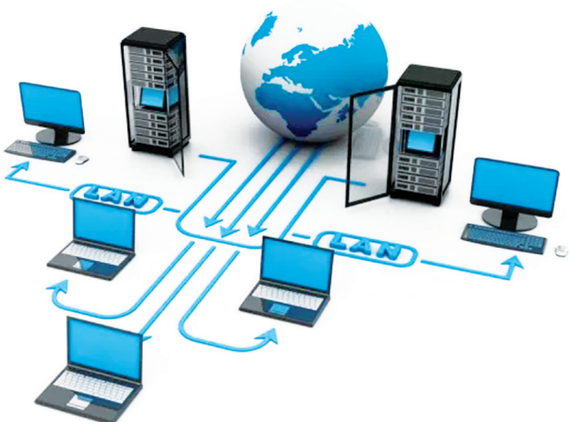


Figure: 4.4 Distributed Operating Systems

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